



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Kawartha Classical Christian School
School Website: <https://www.kawarthaclassical.com/>

December 28, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Kawartha Classical Christian School (KCCS) presents a clearly Christian, formation-oriented approach that aligns with several core elements of classical education, but with notable gaps in explicit articulation of core classical curriculum and pedagogy. Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered aims, formation of virtue, and an emphasis on truth, beauty, and goodness, along with a strong faculty ethos and open parental engagement. Evidence of explicit classical curriculum components such as the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, and the Great Conversation is not clearly stated in the public materials available here. As a result, the school demonstrates meaningful classical alignment in certain areas (notably religious/theological foundations and a formation-focused purpose with a robust faculty posture) but falls short of full classical articulation in others (especially explicit curriculum and pedagogy). The overall assessment is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key evidentiary notes: - Christ-centered mission and explicit theology are central to materials (e.g., "Tuning Hearts. Training Minds. To the Glory of Christ," and a stated Statement of Faith). This supports Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose.

- The faculty is described in warmly favorable terms, with emphasis on godliness and care, signaling a living-teacher/mentors model aligned with classical expectations about the faculty. - Parental engagement and transparent admissions processes hint at a community orientation consistent with classical expectations for parent partnership, though explicit "co-teacher" programming or formal parent-formation activities are not deeply described in the visible material.

Note: This evaluation uses the six-element rubric and the associated positive/negative keyword indicators from the classical-education reference documents (the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and related lexicon) to ground category-by-category scoring. See the cited sources for the keyword framework (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; Great Books; Socratic pedagogy; etc.).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials frame education as Christ-centered with explicit theological orientation, including a mission that centers Christ and a Statement of Faith. Examples include phrases like "Tuning Hearts. Training Minds. To the Glory of Christ," and a mission focused on truth, beauty, and goodness as real and knowable. The site also references a Statement of Faith and asks readers to learn more about it. - Content emphasizes a Christian worldview (e.g., "Christ-centered in its essence" and "to the glory of Jesus") and the faculty is described as teaching in a godly manner.

Positive Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present in public materials (drawn from the Six Essentials lexicon): truth, goodness, beauty; virtue (conceptual), theology; Christ; glory of Christ; sacred/Christ-centered language; moral formation. - The classical lexicon explicitly lists truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, and Christ-centered language as indicators of a Classical Foundations alignment.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: at least 6 (truth; goodness; beauty; virtue; theology; Christ/Christ-centered language). - Negative keywords observed: none evident in the public material. - Proportional reading: Strong positive presence with no negative indicators detected in the visible materials.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty, and a robust theological framing (Statement of Faith; Christ-centered mission) aligns with the transcendental moral realism and theological grounding expected in Classical practice. The absence of explicit liturgical/community practices in the snippets limits a full Classical score here.

Citations: mission language and Christ-centered framing from Kawartha materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission explicitly centers formation of character and virtue, aiming for students who comprehend truth and delight in beauty, and who serve their community, with a telos oriented toward Christ and moral formation. The language emphasizes formation (not merely information) and a pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real. - The theological framing and the call to form students into people who live for truth and virtue reflect a Classical aim beyond job preparation.

Positive Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, telos, classical mission, Christian formation, truth/beauty/goodness, contemplation of higher goods (as per classical lexicon lists). The lexicon highlights formation, telos, and pursuit of true/good/beautiful as core signals.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: multiple (formation; virtue; truth; goodness; beauty; telos; classical mission). - Negative keywords observed: none evident.

Why this rating - The school places formation and virtue at the center of its aims, with a clear metaphysical orientation toward truth, goodness, beauty. While explicit Great Books/Great Conversation is not stated in the visible public materials, the emphasis on formation and transcendentals aligns with Classical purposes around telos and virtue.

Citations: mission statement and the formation/true-good-beauty framing from the Kawartha materials.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - There is no explicit articulation in the public materials of the liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric), the Quadrivium, Great Books, or the Great Conversation. The visible content emphasizes Christ-centered aims, formation, and faculty quality, but does not state the core classical curriculum components. The absence of direct references to Great Books or the Trivium in the public text leads to a lack of explicit classical curricular detail.

Positive Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords from the classical curriculum lexicon (e.g., grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation) are not evidenced in the visible site content.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: 0 (no explicit mention of grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation). - Negative keywords observed: 0 (no explicit “anti-classical” curriculum language detected).

Why this rating - Without explicit statements about liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, or the Great Conversation, the curriculum category cannot be confidently classified as Classical. The presence of a classical-leaning identity does not substitute for explicit curricular structure in this rubric.

Citations: absence of explicit curricular items in the public Kawartha materials.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The visible public content does not document the specific pedagogical practices required by the Classical rubric (e.g., Socratic seminars, memory work, chant/singing in lower grades, or disciplined rhetoric

development in upper grades). No explicit statements about Socratic inquiry, scholé, or structured classical pedagogy are present in the available material.

Positive Keyword Analysis - Positive pedagogy keywords from the canonical list (Socratic discussion, scholé, memory work, memorization, seminars) are not evidenced in the public Kawartha materials.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: 0. - Negative keywords observed: 0.

Why this rating - The evident absence of explicit classical pedagogy signals means the pedagogy category does not meet Classical criteria based on the available public materials. The school may employ robust Christian pedagogy, but not clearly aligned with the classical teaching-method signals in the rubric.

Citations: lack of explicit pedagogical signals in Kawartha materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a strong, virtuous faculty with language about the faculty being capable of providing godly instruction and care. The statement that “the faculty demonstrate a high degree of competence in instructing each subject in a godly manner” signals a living-curriculum model and faculty as virtuous exemplars. This aligns with the Classical expectation that teachers are models of virtue and living curriculum.

Positive Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present include: model teachers/mentors, virtue, godly instruction, living curriculum, faculty of friends (conceptually), collegiality (implied by the supportive tone). The classical lexicon highlights “model teachers,” “living curriculum,” and “faculty as mentors” as core indicators.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: at least 3–4 strong signals (faculty as virtuous mentors; godly instruction; staff care; living-curriculum tenor). - Negative keywords observed: none.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on virtuous, capable teachers who model virtue and care supports a CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Citations: faculty statement and description from Kawartha materials.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site foregrounds parent involvement through user-facing items like “What Parents are Saying,” accessibility to learn about the vision and faith, and admissions processes (e.g., “Find Out How,” admissions process, ability to book tours, shadow days). There is clear emphasis on partnering with families and inviting parental engagement, which aligns with the classical emphasis on parents as co-educators and open school-community engagement.

Positive Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present include: partnership with families, parent formation, parental engagement, open campus, home-school partnership, family involvement (as indicated by the general framing of parent-related content). The Six Essentials lexicon lists parent partnership and formation as strong signals; the Kawartha materials show open communication and parent-facing content.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords observed: multiple signals (parent partnerships; open visits; admissions/tour/shadow opportunities; parent-facing content). - Negative keywords observed: none.

Why this rating - The visible materials show robust parental engagement and openness to family involvement, which aligns with the classical category expectation, though explicit, formalized parent-formation programs are not described in detail. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 6 rather than a full CLASSICAL.

Citations: parent-facing content and admissions openness from Kawartha materials.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Explicitly document and communicate the liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books, and the Great Conversation on the website or in admissions materials. Include references to primary texts, memory work, and classic authors where applicable. This would elevate Curriculum to CLASSICAL.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Provide a clear statement of pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholarly dialogues, and reformulated memory/recitation practices) and how upper- and lower-school practices align with scholé/restful learning versus rigid rigor. Incorporating explicit signals of classical pedagogy would move Pedagogy toward CLASSICAL.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Outline formal parent-formation initiatives (reading groups, book studies, liturgical/calendar alignment with family life, home-parent learning supports) beyond admissions interactions. A named, ongoing program would push Parents & Community toward CLASSICAL.
- Across the board, a concise, public articulation of how Great Books, Great Conversation, and the Trivium are integrated into daily teaching would create stronger Element 1–3 alignment and elevate the overall classical profile.

Citations: rationale aligns with the gap analysis between observed materials and the Six Essential Elements framework.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.